

INTERNATIONAL news

IPC rebrands itself to Global Electronics Association

The Institute for Printed Circuits (IPC) has rebranded as the Global Electronics Association, reflecting its expanded global role in the \$6 trillion electronics industry. The new name clarifies its broader mission, strengthens advocacy, and aligns with its vision: 'Better electronics for a better world.' The 'IPC' name will still be used for standards and certifications.

Semiconductor tariffs lead Trump's new trade offensive

President Trump has announced sweeping new tariffs on semiconductors, copper, and pharmaceuticals to bolster US industry and economic dominance. Key measures include a 50% tariff on copper, 200% on imported drugs (with an 18-month grace period), and a 10% blanket tariff on BRICS nations. He also renewed support for fossil fuels over renewables.

Micron unveils \$200 billion US expansion plan

Micron Technology has announced a massive \$200 billion plan to boost US semiconductor production and R&D. The investment includes a \$30 billion fab in Idaho, upgrades in Virginia, and projects in New York, backed by CHIPS Act funding. Aiming to create 90,000 jobs, Micron seeks to anchor America's lead in next-gen memory and chip technologies.

Texas Instruments invests \$60 billion in US chip manufacturing

Texas Instruments will invest over \$60 billion to expand seven semiconductor plants in Texas and Utah, creating around 60,000 jobs. Touted as the largest-ever US investment in foundational chipmaking, it includes a previously announced \$18 billion Texas project backed by \$1.6 billion in federal subsidies. The move supports US tech resilience amid rising global competition.

UK backs quantum and semiconductors in £1 billion tech push

The United Kingdom has announced over £1 billion to boost its tech sector, with £670 million for quantum computing and £54 million for semiconductors. The plan includes a new Semiconductor Centre and extended talent programmes. Aimed at global leadership by 2035, the funding supports innovation, skills, and supply chain integration under the UK's Digital and Technologies Sector Plan.

Wolfspeed to file for bankruptcy in a debt restructuring plan

US-based firm Wolfspeed plans to file for Chapter 11 bankruptcy to cut \$4.6 billion in debt and slash interest payments by 60%. Despite recent layoffs and facility closures, operations will continue during the restructuring period, backed by creditor support. The silicon carbide chipmaker aims to focus on 200mm wafers and emerge financially stronger by September, aided by CHIPS Act funding.

Nvidia overtakes Microsoft with \$3.76 trillion valuation in early July

Nvidia has become the world's most valuable publicly traded company, reaching a \$3.76 trillion market capitalisation after its shares surged over 4% to a record high of \$154.10. Driven by strong AI demand and an upgraded forecast from Loop Capital, Nvidia overtook Microsoft and Apple. The milestone occurred

in early July 2025; Nvidia reached a \$4 trillion cap on July 9. As of July 15, data confirms that the valuation remains at that peak.

OpenAI dismisses rumours of large-scale shift to Google AI chips

OpenAI has denied plans to widely adopt Google's AI chips, confirming its continued reliance on Nvidia GPUs and AMD hardware. While testing Google's TPUs and using some Google Cloud services, its core infrastructure remains unchanged. OpenAI is also developing its own chip to reduce dependency, with most operations still running on CoreWeave's high-performance GPU platform.

Foxconn sales hit \$18.67 billion, betting on AI and gadget demand

Contract manufacturer Foxconn reported record June sales of NT\$540.24 billion (US\$18.67 billion), up 10% YoY but down 12% from May. Q2 2025 sales reached NT\$1.8 trillion, representing a 15.8% annual increase. The first half of 2025 sales grew nearly 20% YoY. Despite currency pressures and softer client demand, Foxconn plans to deepen its global partnerships and refine its regional strategies for sustained growth ahead.

Samsung profit plunges 56% in 2025 amid AI chip setback

Samsung Electronics reported a 56% drop in Q2 2025 operating profit, the sharpest since 2023, due to US export controls on AI chips to China and a major inventory write-down. Profit fell to \$3.3 billion, missing forecasts, while rivals gained ground. Samsung expects a gradual recovery in chip demand and improved foundry performance in the second half of the year.

Intel layoffs surpass 1600 across the US

Intel is cutting 1666 US jobs: 855 in California, 529 in Oregon, 172 in Arizona, and 110 in Texas, as well as hundreds more in Israel, as it restructures under CEO Lip-Bu Tan. Aiming to streamline operations and boost engineering and AI focus, Intel seeks to eliminate bureaucracy, improve execution, and strengthen its foundry business amid growing global competition.

Microchip and partners unveil ASA-ML camera ecosystem in Japan

Microchip, partnering with Nippon Chemi-Con and NetVision, has launched Japan's first ASA-ML camera development ecosystem to support open, standardised connectivity for ADAS. Built on Microchip's VS775S chipset, the platform enables secure, high-speed video links and multi-vendor compatibility. Looking to replace proprietary systems, the solution supports Japan's evolving automotive cybersecurity standards.

Microsoft's AI chip launch pushed to 2026 amid internal setbacks

Microsoft's AI chip, Braga, has been delayed to 2026 due to design changes, staffing issues, and team turnover. Part of the Maia series, Braga lags behind Nvidia's Blackwell chips in performance. As rivals like Google and Amazon advance their in-house processors, the delay could impact Microsoft's AI infrastructure plans amid rising industry demand.